

TEXT OF TELEGRAM 86STATE 327693

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FOR DCN/POLITICAL COUNSELOR FROM EUR/NE WHITLOCK

E.O. 12958 N/A

TAGS: PREL

SUBJECT: OFFICIAL-INFORMAL

1. EUR HAS DISTRIBUTED THE FOLLOWING UNCLASSIFIED
TALKING POINTS ON THE US/SOVIET MEETINGS IN REYKJAVIK
FOR USE HERE BY COUNTRY DESKS. YOU AND YOUR OFFICERS
MAY WISH TO USE THEM IN DISCUSSIONS WITH LOCAL
CONTACTS. THERE ARE NO STATED RESTRICTIONS ON USE OF
THE PAPER BUT IT SHOULD BE USED WITH APPROPRIATE
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DISCRETION.

BEGIN TEXT

GENERAL

--THE PRESIDENT AGREED TO GENERAL SECRETARY GORBACHEV'S
SUGGESTION OF A MEETING IN ICELAND IN ORDER TO ADVANCE
PROSPECTS FOR MEANINGFUL AGREEMENT ON THE WHOLE RANGE

DEPARTMENT OF STATE A/CDC/MR

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OF US/SOVIET ISSUES - REGIONAL, BILATERAL, AND HUMAN RIGHTS, AS WELL AS ARMS CONTROL.

--WE ARE DISAPPOINTED THAT THE SOVIETS CHOSE NOT TO SEIZE THE OPPORTUNITY AT REYKJAVIK FOR FAR-REACHING AGREEMENTS IN SEVERAL AREAS. THEY INSTEAD INSISTED ON

CONTINUING TO TRY TO CRIPPLE US EFFORTS TO INVESTIGATE THE PROSPECTS FOR STRATEGIC DEFENSE.

--NEVERTHELESS, GREAT STRIDES WERE MADE ACROSS THE BOARD, ESPECIALLY IN ARMS CONTROL. IMPORTANT POSSIBILITIES FOR A FAR SAFER AND MORE STABLE WORLD IN THE FUTURE HAVE BEEN OPENED UP.

--THE IDEAS THAT EMERGED IN ICELAND WILL NOT GO AWAY. THE US INTENDS TO PICK UP THE DIALOGUE WHERE IT ENDED IN REYKJAVIK, AND WILL CONTINUE TO PRESS FORWARD TOWARD AGREEMENTS.

HUMAN RIGHTS

--THE PRESIDENT MADE CLEAR THAT SOVIET STEPS ON HUMAN RIGHTS ISSUES WOULD OPEN UP POSSIBILITIES FOR ACHIEVING UNCLASSIFIED UNCLASSIFIED

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OUR BROADER GOALS.

--THE PRESIDENT UNDERSCORED THE IMPORTANCE THE WORLD ATTACHES TO SOVIET COMPLIANCE WITH THE 1975 HELSINKI ACCORDS.....

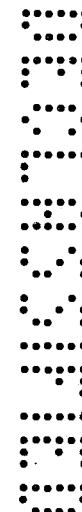
--IT IS SIGNIFICANT THAT THE SOVIETS WERE WILLING TO ACKNOWLEDGE PUBLICLY THAT "HUMAN RIGHTS"--NOT JUST "HUMANITARIAN ISSUES"--HAD BEEN DISCUSSED, AND THAT SUCH EXCHANGES WOULD CONTINUE.

--THE US PLACED PARTICULAR EMPHASIS ON SOVIET VIOLATIONS OF THE HUMAN RIGHTS OF THOSE SEEKING EMIGRATION FOR REASONS OF RELIGIOUS LIBERTY AND FAMILY REUNIFICATION.

REGIONAL ISSUES

--THE US RAISED REGIONAL ISSUES SUCH AS AFGHANISTAN, ANGOLA, NICARAGUA AND CAMBODIA.

--THESE CONFLICTS LIE AT THE HEART OF THE DIFFERENCES BETWEEN THE SOVIET UNION AND AMERICA. UNTIL SOVIET POLICIES CHANGE, THE US WILL MAKE SURE THAT OUR FRIENDS IN THOSE AREAS HAVE THE SUPPORT THEY NEED.



BILATERAL RELATIONS

--AT THE NOVEMBER 1985 GENEVA SUMMIT, SEVERAL CULTURAL EXCHANGE ACCORDS WERE REACHED. IN REYKJAVIK, THERE WERE INDICATIONS OF MORE MOVEMENT IN A VARIETY OF AREAS.

--THE US REMAINS COMMITTED TO PEOPLE-TO-PEOPLE PROGRAMS THAT COULD FOSTER EXCHANGES AMONG THOUSANDS OF EVERYDAY US AND SOVIET CITIZENS.

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ARMS CONTROL

--THE REYKJAVIK DISCUSSIONS COVERED ARMS CONTROL IN GREAT DEPTH. WE WERE SURPRISED THAT THE SOVIETS WERE FINALLY READY TO TALK IN SO MUCH DETAIL ABOUT SOME OF THE OBSTACLES TO PROGRESS.

--THE REYKJAVIK MEETING BROUGHT THE TWO SIDES CLOSER THAN EVER BEFORE TO AGREEMENTS THAT COULD LEAD TO A SAFER WORLD WITHOUT NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

--THE PRESIDENT MADE THE MOST SWEEPING AND GENEROUS ARMS CONTROL OFFER IN HISTORY. IT REMAINS ON THE TABLE. WE HOPE THE SOVIETS WILL RECONSIDER IT.

STRATEGIC ARMS REDUCTIONS (START)

--THE TWO SIDES CAME CLOSE TO AGREEMENT BASED ON THE APPROACH AGREED AT THE NOVEMBER 1985 SUMMIT: FIFTY PER CENT INITIAL REDUCTIONS IN STRATEGIC FORCES.

--THIS COMPARES FAVORABLY WITH EARLIER INDICATIONS FROM THE SOVIETS THAT THEY WERE ONLY PREPARED FOR LESS SWEEPING REDUCTIONS.

--AS DISCUSSED IN REYKJAVIK, STRATEGIC OFFENSIVE FORCES WOULD BE REDUCED TO 1600 STRATEGIC NUCLEAR DELIVERY VEHICLES, WITH 6000 WARHEADS.

--THIRTY FIFTY PER CENT CUTS WOULD BE APPLIED TO SPECIFIC TYPES OF STRATEGIC WEAPONS IN EACH SIDE'S ARSENALS. THIS IS AN IMPORTANT ADVANCE:

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-----IT MEETS THE SPECIAL CONCERNS OF BOTH SIDES
-----WITHOUT IMPOSING A RESTRUCTURING OF EITHER SIDE'S

-----FORCES.

-----FOR THE FIRST TIME, IT REPRESENTS SOVIET RECOGNITION OF THE NEED FOR SIGNIFICANT CUTS IN THEIR HEAVY ICBMS.

INTERMEDIATE-RANGE NUCLEAR FORCES (INF)

--THERE WERE LENGTHY EXCHANGES ON INF. THE US HELD FIRM ON INSISTING ON GLOBAL LIMITS AND REDUCTIONS OF

SOVIET MISSILES IN ASIA, AND ON REJECTING THE SOVIET EFFORT TO CLAIM "COMPENSATION" FOR THIRD-COUNTRY FORCES.

--ALTHOUGH IT WAS NOT WORKED OUT IN DETAIL, THE ELEMENTS OF A POSSIBLE AGREEMENT EMERGED THAT WOULD HAVE REDUCED THE LONGER-RANGE INF MISSILES ON BOTH SIDES SUBSTANTIALLY, WITH COLLATERAL LIMITS ON SHORTER-RANGE INF MISSILES.

--SPECIFICALLY, GORBACHEV AGREED TO A GLOBAL CEILING OF 100 LRINF WARHEADS FOR EACH SIDE -- 100 FOR THE SOVIETS IN ASIA AND 100 FOR THE US IN THE UNITED STATES

--THIS REPRESENTS OVER A NINETY PER CENT REDUCTION IN THE SS-20 THREAT.

--WESTERN SOLIDARITY WAS AN INVALUABLE ELEMENT IN BRINGING THE SOVIET UNION TO THE POINT WHERE A COMPREHENSIVE INF AGREEMENT WAS WITHIN REACH. IT WILL REMAIN JUST AS ESSENTIAL AS WE PRESS IN GENEVA FOR FURTHER PROGRESS.

--THE CONTRAST BETWEEN THE SITUATION NOW AND THREE UNCLASSIFIED UNCLASSIFIED

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YEARS AGO WHEN NATO LRINF DEPLOYMENTS BEGAN AND THE SOVIETS CLAIMED THEY WOULD NEVER RETURN TO THE TABLE WHILE US LRINF MISSILES REMAINED IN EUROPE -- IS VIVID TESTIMONY OF HOW FAR WE HAVE COME TOWARD REAL REDUCTIONS OFFENSIVE NUCLEAR ARSENALS.

DEFENSE AND SPACE

--BOTH SIDES RECOGNIZE THE INTERRELATIONSHIP OF OFFENSE AND DEFENSE.

--THE 1972 ABM TREATY WAS BASED ON THE PREMISE THAT IF THE DEFENSES OF BOTH SIDES WERE SHARPLY LIMITED, OFFENSIVE REDUCTIONS WOULD FOLLOW.

--THIS PREMISE HAS PROVED FALSE: FOR 14 YEARS, THE

SOVIETS HAVE BEEN UNWILLING TO SIGN AN AGREEMENT REDUCING STRATEGIC NUCLEAR ARSENALS. THUS, THE TOP PRIORITY IN ARMS CONTROL MUST BE TO ACHIEVE THE LEP AND STABILIZING REDUCTIONS IN OFFENSIVE FORCES THAT THE ABM TREATY WAS INTENDED TO BRING ABOUT.

--AT THE SAME TIME, THE US STRATEGIC DEFENSE INITIATIVE (SDI) IS PURSUING ADVANCED NON-NUCLEAR TECHNOLOGIES FOR DEFENSES AGAINST BALLISTIC MISSILES -- DEFENSE SYSTEMS THAT ARE SURVIVABLE AND COST-EFFECTIVE AT THE MARGIN.

SDI RESEARCH IS CONDUCTED IN FULL COMPLIANCE WITH ALL US TREATY OBLIGATIONS.

--AT REYKJAVIK, THE US MADE THE FOLLOWING PROPOSALS:

----- BOTH SIDES WOULD BE CONFINED FOR FIVE YEARS TO
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----- RESEARCH, TESTING, AND DEVELOPMENT OF DEFENSIVE
SYSTEMS AS PERMITTED BY THE ABM TREATY, DURING
WHICH TIME OFFENSIVE STRATEGIC ARSENALS OF BOTH
SIDES WOULD BE REDUCED BY 50 PERCENT;

----- REDUCTIONS WOULD CONTINUE FOR THE NEXT FIVE
YEARS, DURING WHICH TIME ALL OFFENSIVE BALLISTIC
MISSILES WOULD BE ELIMINATED WHILE STRATEGIC
DEFENSES WOULD CONTINUE TO BE RESTRICTED;

----- AT THE END OF TEN YEARS, WITH ALL OFFENSIVE
BALLISTIC MISSILES ELIMINATED, EITHER SIDE COULD
DEPLOY DEFENSIVE SYSTEMS AS AN INSURANCE POLICY.

--HOWEVER, THE SOVIETS INSISTED IN REYKJAVIK THAT THE
US MUST AGREE TO A NEW VERSION OF THE 1972 ABM TREATY,
A TREATY WHICH THE SOVIETS ARE ALREADY VIOLATING. THEY
WANTED TO REDEFINE THAT TREATY TO FORBID ANY WORK
OUTSIDE THE LABORATORY -- IN EFFECT, TO KILL SDI.

--THE PRESIDENT MADE CLEAR THAT THIS IS UNACCEPTABLE.
THE US WILL NOT BARGAIN AWAY SDI. IT IS WHAT BROUGHT
THE SOVIETS BACK TO ARMS CONTROL TALKS, AND IT IS
ESSENTIAL TO OUR LONG-TERM GOAL OF A WORLD WITHOUT
NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

--WITHOUT SDI AS AN INSURANCE POLICY, THERE WOULD BE NO
GUARANTEE THAT THE SOVIETS WOULD KEEP THE COMMITMENTS
THEY TALKED ABOUT AT REYKJAVIK. ALL NATIONS WOULD
REMAIN DEFENSELESS AGAINST BALLISTIC MISSILES, WHETHER
FIRED BY ACCIDENT OR DESIGN.

--THE SOVIETS UNDERSTAND THE IMPORTANCE OF SDI. THEY

HAVE DEVOTED FAR MORE RESOURCES THAN THE US, FOR A LONGER TIME, TO THEIR OWN VERSION OF SOI.

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--IT IS IMPORTANT TO NOTE THAT, WHILE VERY SIGNIFICANT DIFFERENCES REMAIN IN THEIR OVERALL APPROACHES, BOTH SIDES MOVED ON THE MINIMUM TIMES FOR LIMITING THEMSELVES TO RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND TESTING: THE US ORIGINALLY WANTED SEVEN AND A HALF YEARS, THE SOVIETS FIFTEEN YEARS; THE TWO SIDES AGREED ON TEN YEARS.

NUCLEAR TESTING

....
-- THE US AND ITS ALLIES DEPEND ON NUCLEAR DETERRENCE FOR THEIR SECURITY. AS LONG AS THIS IS SO, SOME MEASURE OF TESTING WILL REMAIN NECESSARY. HOWEVER, PRACTICAL STEPS TOWARD TESTING LIMITATIONS CAN BE TAKEN NOW. AT REYKJAVIK, THE US STRESSED THE NEED TO AGREE ON EFFECTIVE VERIFICATION OF EXISTING TREATIES (ON PEACEFUL NUCLEAR EXPLOSIONS (PNET) AND THRESHOLD TEST BAN (TTBT)) AS THE ESSENTIAL NEXT STEP.

....
-- THE PRESIDENT INTENDS TO SUBMIT THE TTBT AND PNET TO THE NEXT SESSION OF CONGRESS FOR RATIFICATION; THEIR ENTRY INTO FORCE WOULD BE CONTINGENT ON US/SOVIET AGREEMENT ON EFFECTIVE VERIFICATION MEASURES.

....
-- THE PRESIDENT ALSO MADE CLEAR HIS COMMITMENT TO PROCEED, ONCE THESE TREATIES ARE RATIFIED, TO NEGOTIATE WITH THE SOVIETS ON A STEP-BY-STEP PROGRAM OF FURTHER TESTING LIMITATIONS, IN PARALLEL WITH REDUCTIONS IN NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

....
--WHILE ASPECTS OF THE EXCHANGE ON TESTING WERE ENCOURAGING, FOLLOW-UP US/SOVIET EXPERTS' MEETINGS WILL BE NEEDED TO WORK OUT THE NECESSARY VERIFICATION
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IMPROVEMENTS IN EXISTING TREATIES.

NEXT STEPS

--THE WEST IS IN A STRONG POSITION TO CONTINUE INTENSIVE NEGOTIATIONS FOR READ REDUCTIONS IN NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

--THE PROPOSALS MADE BY THE US AT REYKJAVIK REMAIN ON

THE TABLE. WE WILL PURSUE THEM VIGOROUSLY AT THE
NUCLEAR AND SPACE TALKS IN GENEVA.

--THE SOVIETS HAVE ALSO INDICATED THAT VARIOUS ITEMS
REMAIN ON THE TABLE. WE HOPE THIS IS SO.

--THE US IS PREPARED TO MOVE FORWARD WHENEVER AND
WHEREVER THE SOVIETS ARE READY. SHULTZ

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